



A FREE GUIDE FROM BUILT BY SYSTEMS

The First-Year Homeowner Maintenance Calendar



What to check, and when — your whole first year on
one simple schedule.

How to use this calendar

Owning a home rarely goes wrong in one dramatic moment. It goes wrong in the small things that quietly pile up — the filter nobody changed, the gutter nobody cleaned, the water heater nobody flushed.

The average homeowner spent \$8,808 on maintenance last year, and more than half still got blindsided by a major repair. Almost everyone says upkeep matters; very few have a system for actually doing it.

This calendar is that system, in its simplest form. Each month lists a handful of small jobs that protect the most expensive parts of your house. Do them in order, check them off, and you head off the repairs that wreck a budget.

Print it for the fridge or keep it on your phone. Five minutes a month is the whole plan.

Brand new? Start here.

Before anything else: find your water shut-off valves, test every smoke and CO detector, and change the HVAC filter. The rest builds from there.

Your first-year maintenance calendar

MONTHS 1-6

January

- ☐ Add weatherstripping to drafty doors & windows
- ☐ Test smoke & CO detectors
- ☐ Replace the HVAC filter
- ☐ Watch the roof for ice dams after snow

February

- ☐ Check the attic for moisture or leaks
- ☐ Vacuum the refrigerator coils
- ☐ Flush sediment from the water heater
- ☐ Tighten loose handles & hinges

March

- ☐ Inspect the roof & flashing for winter damage
- ☐ Clean gutters and downspouts
- ☐ Test the sump pump before spring rain
- ☐ Service the lawn mower

April

- ☐ Have the AC serviced before summer
- ☐ Reseal exterior caulking & gaps
- ☐ Check outdoor faucets for leaks
- ☐ Clean the window screens

May

- ☐ Inspect and reseal the deck or patio
- ☐ Check the foundation for cracks
- ☐ Clean the dryer vent & lint duct
- ☐ Fertilize and reseed the lawn

June

- ☐ Deep-clean and inspect the grill
- ☐ Repair torn window & door screens
- ☐ Test the garage door auto-reverse
- ☐ Wash the exterior windows

Your first-year maintenance calendar

MONTHS 7-12

July

- ☐ Replace the HVAC filter
- ☐ Check washing-machine hoses for wear
- ☐ Look under sinks for slow leaks
- ☐ Clean the bathroom exhaust fans

August

- ☐ Check attic insulation & ventilation
- ☐ Touch up exterior paint and trim
- ☐ Check the fire extinguisher charge
- ☐ Clear debris from the AC unit

September

- ☐ Service the furnace before heating season
- ☐ Clean gutters as leaves start to fall
- ☐ Inspect the chimney & book a sweep
- ☐ Reverse ceiling-fan direction

October

- ☐ Drain & shut off outdoor faucets
- ☐ Replace detector batteries
- ☐ Seal driveway cracks before frost
- ☐ Refresh worn weatherstripping

November

- ☐ Flush the water heater
- ☐ Winterize the sprinkler system
- ☐ Stock salt, sand & a good shovel
- ☐ Insulate exposed pipes

December

- ☐ Inspect the roof before snow load
- ☐ Test backup heat or generator
- ☐ Re-test smoke & CO detectors
- ☐ Review home inventory & insurance



Want it to remind you?

This calendar tells you what and when. The First-Year Homeowner Kit does the remembering for you — a month-by-month tracker, a week-one move-in checklist, a starter home inventory, and one place for every warranty and document. One file you own. No subscription.

Get the Kit — \$19 →

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